

G O D SPEED

Sloth! One of the seven deadly sins, and your PC is committing it right now. Give it a shot of the steroid called upgrade, and start your life in the gigahertz world

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Your PC used to be a rocket once, but that's all history now. All you can do now is consider putting this ancient tortoise out of its misery. Sounds familiar? Does your PC take over 45 seconds to start? Can you finish reading this entire article while waiting for Adobe Photoshop to open that 10 MB TIF file? It's time for an upgrade! And there's no need to call in a team of hardware engineers either—we'll help you do it all by yourself! Enough talk—time to get those hands dirty.

STEP 1 First and most important, shut down the PC normally, and disconnect the power cord from the mains. Then disconnect all peripherals such as the keyboard, the mouse, the printer etc. from the cabinet. Set the cabinet gently on a flat surface on its side.

STEP 2 Before opening the side panel, ground yourself completely and get

rid of any electrostatic charge on your hands, by touching any metallic surface. This is very important, as these random charges can damage the motherboard's delicate electronics.

STEP 3 After opening the side panel, look for the processor with the fan and heatsink sitting on top of it, which is usually somewhere close to the centre of the motherboard.

First, you need to disconnect the fan's power supply. To do this, just locate a thin group of three wires leading away from the fan, and gently pull out the connector linking these wires to the motherboard.

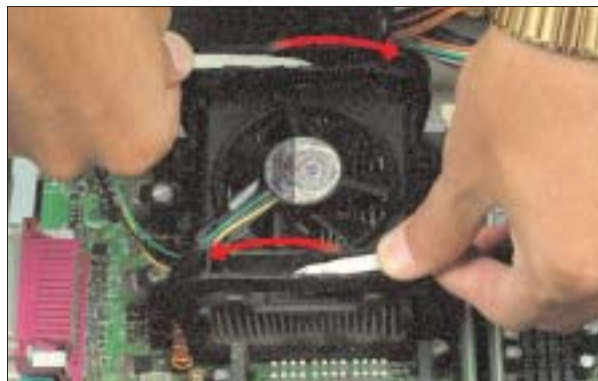
At this time, it might be a good idea to remove the graphics card as well, if there is very little room to manoeuvre within the cabinet. Now to release the heatsink-fan assembly, you'll find two clips holding it in place.

STEP 4 These clips swing in both directions, but to release them, the clamps have to be opened

outwards in an anti-clockwise direction, till they snap open and release the plastic holding mechanism for the heatsink (See picture Step 4).

STEP 5 Gently pull out the heatsink to expose the processor, using both hands (See picture Step 5a). Pull the heatsink and fan out of the cabinet before you attempt to remove the CPU (See picture Step 5b). Release the catch next to the processor's socket, and pull the CPU free from the socket (See picture Step 5c).

STEP 6 Unpack the new processor and plug it gently into the socket. While doing so, look for a small indicator on the processor itself, and then match it with an identical mark on the socket below, corresponding to the pin layout on the CPU and the socket (See picture Step 6). Do not apply any undue force, because if you find



Step 4: Open the clips holding the heatsink, as shown above